RSS Digest
Generated at: 2026-10-25 13:47:15

1. battledrones v14: Compass Rose, a four player map
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-24T03:59:57+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/24/battledrones/
Release: battledrones v14: Compass Rose, a four player map I added four player online mode to Battledrones - previous maps were limited to two. Here’s the initial prompt I used: Add a new map for a four player battle - four way rotational symmetry, up to four AI players, works with the WebSocket non-audio based multiplayer mode so up to four human players can join (any spare slots use AI) Claude Opus 5.5 added a new map called "Compass Rose" and modified the WebSockets multiplayer network code to support up to four players for that map, joining via share links or QR codes. The new teams use robots themed in purple and green, joining the existing blue and red designs. You can preview those colors in the updated model browser . Here’s a replay link to watch a four way AI battle with the "Goliath Armada" mutator turned on, where each side starts with four giant Goliath mech units. Tags: game-design , projects , claude

2. Nicole Nguyen?s Duo Review for the WSJ
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-24T22:15:00Z
Link: https://www.wsj.com/tech/personal-tech/iphone-duo-review-cafcbbe7?st=GaYVMf
Nicole Nguyen (also with a 5-minute video), writing for The Wall Street Journal (gift link): Every time I used the Duo in phone mode, one-handed, I felt its heft. It?s wider and thicker than a Pro iPhone ? and heavier, even compared with competing foldables. My hand actually hurts after using the Duo nonstop, straining to grip the device securely while trying to reach the far edge of the screen. An Apple spokesman pointed to the Duo?s titanium frame for durability. Other folding models use a lighter aluminum. The company also moved the dock and common controls to the right to be more reachable (sorry, southpaws). Still, there were plenty of instances where my thumb found its limits: turning off the flash in the camera app, or typing the letter ?A.? There are people who can easily use two hands and won?t see this as a problem, including train commuters, frequent fliers or parents who wait around for kids to finish their activities. For me, I look forward to the day the Duo is lighter and thinner ? maybe folding to the size of a deck of cards, like in the movie ?Her.? Interesting that she?d prefer a smaller Duo, not a bigger one , if Apple makes a second size. I agree that one-hand...

3. Reuters and the WSJ on the Duo Launch
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-24T22:08:17Z
Link: https://www.reuters.com/business/retail-consumer/apple-bets-iphone-duo-can-remake-foldable-market-sales-begin-2026-10-22/
Aditya Soni, Christine Chen, and Will Russell, reporting Friday for Reuters: CEO Ternus played greeter at a store in Austin, Texas, throwing open the doors and high-fiving customers as they streamed in, a video ?posted on X by CBS Austin showed. A known car enthusiast, Ternus?s Austin visit coincides with this weekend?s Formula 1 US Grand Prix in the city, with Apple holding exclusive US broadcast and streaming rights to the racing series. I was wondering why Ternus and retail chief Deirdre O?Brien were in Austin for the launch. Joz held down the fort and held court at the Fifth Avenue store. Regarding reviews: They also said the folded Duo is less handy for the quick tasks most users do daily and several prominent reviewers recommended against it for many Apple customers. ?It?s been a lot of fun trying the Duo out for a week, but it feels like I?ve gotten to use an extraordinarily polished prototype ? not a finished product that I?d want to buy and carry,? wrote longtime Apple commentator John Gruber. Tech commentator Marques Brownlee said in a YouTube ?review that for a regular person who mostly texts and browses, ?it is probably a no. But if the $2,000 doesn?t mean much to you,...

4. Marion Barry Meets the iPhone Duo
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-24T21:10:06Z
Link: https://www.theverge.com/tech/1017623/iphone-duo-broken-cracked-screen

Jay Peters, The Verge: The iPhone Duo officially goes on sale today, but a few units already have broken screens. According to posts on Reddit about the affected units, the issue appears to be happening at a similar spot on all of them: Some kind of problem shows up on the inner screen along the hinge and a strange bright line (or lines) across the right side of the display. This crack problem doesn?t seem to be widespread, but it?s seemingly more than a handful . ?

5. Don’t anthropomorphize big tech companies
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 25 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/dont-anthropomorphize-big-tech-companies/
Bryan Cantrill has a great line from a talk where he cautions against anthropomorphizing 1 Oracle CEO Larry Ellison. I think it?s also a mistake to treat any tech company like a person. Here?s the full quote: You need to think of Larry Ellison the way you think of a lawnmower. You don?t anthropomorphize your lawnmower, the lawnmower just mows the lawn, you stick your hand in there and it?ll chop it off, the end. You don?t think ?oh, the lawnmower hates me? ? lawnmower doesn?t give a shit about you, lawnmower can?t hate you. Don?t anthropomorphize the lawnmower. Don?t fall into that trap about Oracle. Companies are machines, not persons Here are some examples of anthropomorphizing companies: My company really owes me for that hard thing I did I?m fighting the good fight against my company on issue X (e.g. accessibility) and they hate me for it My company is vindictively retaliating against me because of that mistake I made My company and I are partners in the mission to make the world a better place All of these are mistakes. Your relationship to the tech company that employs you is not like a relationship with a person. It?s more like your relationship with your car 2 . If you dri...

6. Computing polar triangles with linear algebra
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 25 Oct 2026 01:01:55 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/24/computing-polar-triangles/
The previous post defined the polar triangle of a spherical triangle in terms of its sides and angles, but it doesn?t construct the triangle. It only specifies one of a family of triangles located anywhere on the sphere. How do we know that polar triangles exist? There is a geometric construction that starts with a [?] The post Computing polar triangles with linear algebra first appeared on John D. Cook .

7. Duality in spherical trigonometry
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 25 Oct 2026 00:28:20 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/24/polar-triangle/
I?ve written before about the law of cosines on a sphere: cos(c) = cos(a) cos(b) + sin(a) sin(b) cos(C). But that?s just one of two laws of cosines on a sphere. The equation above is the law of cosines for sides. The law of cosines for angles is typographically very similar, just inverting the case of [?] The post Duality in spherical trigonometry first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. List of Vim forks
Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Sat, 24 Oct 2026 17:00:00 +0000
Link: https://evanhahn.com/list-of-vim-forks/
Here are the Vim forks I know about: Neovim : ?a Vim-based text editor engineered for extensibility and usability, to encourage new applications and contributions.? Vim Classic : ?a stable, long-term support fork of the ubiquitous text editor, maintained without the assistance of generative AI tools.? EVi : ?a hard-fork of Vim v9.1.0 (Jan 2024) before AI was used in the project.? MacVim : ?a macOS version of the Vim text editor, providing a graphical user interface for Vim, while tightly integrating with macOS and providing features specific to the platform.? This list doesn?t include Vim-inspired editors like Kakoune , Vim-style plugins for other editors like IdeaVim , or Vim ?distributions? like LazyVim . Contact me if you know of other forks!

9. Book Review: Get Ahead of Being Dead by Evie King ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 24 Oct 2026 11:34:25 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/book-review-get-ahead-of-being-dead-by-evie-king/
After reading Evie King's previous book Ashes To Admin - Tales from the Caseload of a Council Funeral Officer I was eager to read her not-quite-a-sequel. We know what happens after death; paperwork. Gas bills need to be cancelled, funeral wishes need to be carried out, money needs to be apportioned between warring family members. When you die, you won't be there to experience the annoyance and ?

10. Reading List 10/24/26
Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 24 Oct 2026 12:01:24 GMT
Link: https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-102426
Minimum lot sizes, Boeing?s next 737 MAX, Fervo short sellers, Figure AI?s training data, and more.

11. This Week in Package Management: 24 October 2026
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-24T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/24/this-week-in-package-management.html
This week?s package management news, and what a week it?s been, gathered from the package manager OPML feed collection , my posts and boosts on Mastodon , and anything people sent me. The compromised eMudhra intermediate CAs led to security releases from dozens of package managers, language runtimes and CA bundles this week. Security eMudhra generated eight of its intermediate CA certificates in a way that lets anyone recover their private keys . Browsers blocked them through their revocation lists, and tools that bundle their own copy of the roots shipped new releases. I wrote about where those copies end up, and how many critical packages bundle a CA file, in Trust Stores Are Dependencies Too . The disclosure page keeps a table of patched software with version numbers, including ca-certificates updates for most Linux distributions and the BSDs. The package management releases with the fix: uv 0.13.4 updates the roots compiled into uv, and 0.13.5 updates the managed CPython builds so their pip and ensurepip carry certifi 2026.10.19 pip 26.2.2 Seth Larson?s notice for Python users lists the minimum versions of certifi, pip, uv, sigstore, conda and pixi, and gives a hash-pinned com...

12. MacOS Extensions pack for the Apple Network Server v1.0
Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-10-24T18:21:15.939-07:00
Link: https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/10/macos-extensions-pack-for-apple-network.html
By now regular readers of this blog are quite familiar with my affection for the 1996 Apple Network Server , Apple's Unix-through-and-through $10,000+ server that only shipped with, and only officially ran, Harpoon, its unique superset of IBM AIX. An ANS 500, the lower tier of this dorm fridge-sized computer, was the first server I ever personally owned, a nearly-new hand-me-down after Steve Jobs convinced Gil Amelio to cancel the machine and the bookstore's vendor at the University I worked for wouldn't support it anymore. There are several fascinating features present in Harpoon that were never implemented in any other Apple product. Currently I have three, that original ANS 500, this ANS 700 here which I use for testing, and a battery-bombed EVT prototype (a so-called "Shiner ESB" that used to be at Netscape). The ANS was strongly based on the Power Macintosh 9500 and Apple was known to have demonstrated the ANS with Mac OS during development, but this confused potential buyers, causing the ability to boot Mac OS to be stripped from production systems. While then-CTO Ellen Hancock claimed in 1997 a ROM swap would enable the ANS to boot Mac OS again and Windows NT, these ROMs w...

13. Elon Musk Just Gave Europe a Reason to Replace American Technology
Source: Steve Blank | Published: Sat, 24 Oct 2026 13:00:33 +0000
Link: https://steveblank.com/2026/10/24/europe-gets-a-wake-up-call/
I?ve been in London for the last month and have heard policymakers react to the wake up call Elon Musk just delivered. The decision of the U.S. to shut off intelligence and throttle the military version of Starlink called Starshield to Ukraine may have been a blip in the news in

the US, but it [?]

14. Interesting systemd features you may not know about
Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Sat, 24 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/interesting-systemd-features/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed
Memory caps, run time limits, sleep inhibitors, better cron and path units - systemd features that turn out to be handy for running throwaway agent-written code.